

The Long Rest

Tuesday, 25 August 2026

The Broken Heart of Greenrest · ran ~2h52m (7:43–10:36 PM ET) · canonical GM record — numbers welcome here; the player-safe version is [recap.html](#).

TL;DR. The party limped out of the Hollow and spent three days in Greenrest: Thomas's Exhaustion arc played out exactly as scripted (cane, church, real beds), the shared Dream A.1 fired twice — the second time Jetten answered the dryad by holding out the Graveheart, and her eyes widened before the dream cut — and the town RP menu got a nearly full workout (Selma, Gully, Wend, Enid, Coll, Pip, Oswin, the tree). They chose the **Widow Fen (hag coven)** as site 2 — the soft-steer away did not hold. On the road out they fought **Longshadow + 2 perytons** (the second peryton went in after all) and won without a scratch that lasted. **Level 5 announced at the wrap**; players level in downtime. Next session targeted for **Monday 2026-08-31** (a player travels on the Tuesday).

1 · The walk out

- Morgash found Thomas's cane-stick (Survival 17); Jetten rolled a **nat-20 Cartographer's Tools check (25)** making a proper map of the route home — no wandering encounters, arrival at dusk. Thomas at Exhaustion 2 couldn't carry his own shield; the party carried it.
- Robert had the party scan for **dead fields** approaching town (Chauntea's Barley-Token clue) — none seen; the valley is all bloom.

2 · Arrival and night one — Dream A.1

- Warin's scout welcomed them as heroes (displacer-beast news had spread). Ambrose comped dinner. A healer was sent for: she waved holly, prayed to Chauntea, rubbed healing herbs on Thomas's face — **nothing worked**, first live demonstration that no divine magic answers in Greenrest. She suggested the church infirmary.
- **Dream A.1 fired night one, shared, all four** — delivered as scripted with one live addition: **Jetten's moonstone necklace glowed green inside the dream**. The woman called them "Corin." Waking: Exhaustion → 1, and the **Clear Hollowed** receipt posted publicly (Gren 26/26, Morgash 48/48, Thomas 16/36).
- Morning breakfast interrogation of Ambrose: tonic weekly "like medicine," taken since childhood, "dead dryad haunts our dreams," Selma brews it, been that way for generations. Thomas faked exhaustion (Deception 13 — Ambrose didn't care), slipped upstairs, and cast *Detect Poison and Disease* over tonic and food: **clean**. (Detect Magic not prepared — the tonic's nature stays open.)

3 · The town day — RP menu, nearly cleared

- **Selma:** wares shown, tonic recipe explained (berries, strained apple, a secret garden herb — "perfectly harmless, it just stops you dreaming"), recipe inherited from the apothecary before her 20–30 years back; the dryad is just "the dreamer." Gren's Insight (with *Guidance*, 14): **she reads honest**. The party disclosed the Kestrels' fate; Selma opened a Silver Kestrel Locket and found **Marn's Unsent Letter**, read aloud in full (the "four old places... the prize lies in exactly one... the shrine wasn't a shrine. A graveyard" text + the house by the tannery for Tess). She promised to have the corpses seen to and to tell Oswin. Sold the party 4× Antitoxin (200 gp) and bought Sera's Longbow (25 gp).
- **Gully:** repaired Brakk's Claw-Rent Plate overnight in trade for **2 Necrotic Swords** (party kept the third to show around) — he wants to study them to learn better smithing. Ran exactly as canon: narration, DM-priced, no shop.
- **Mother Wend:** big sell-off (crossbow 12g5s, shortsword 5g, studded leather 22g5s, maul 5g, sickle 5s, shield 5g, a splint suit 100g) + kit purchases. Town lore delivered through her: settlement founded around the tree in a fogless valley, endless summer, fruit four times a year, **two years' mandatory militia service**, and the demographic tell — no elves/gnomes stay ("fey-born never seem to trust us"), one dwarf left generations back. ⚠ **Jetten bought ball bearings and caltrops but NOT arrows — still 0 ordinary arrows.**
- **The church + Enid:** Thomas's Investigation (advantage as a Lathander devotee, 21): even the **original stonework is all fruits and farming** — built *for* Chauntea by people who didn't understand her ways. Enid admitted the goddess has never answered her spells, looked doubtful about the luxury ("I didn't choose this"), and showed them the basement on prodding — innocently gilded farm utensils. Her first hairline cracks, on schedule.
- **Graveyard mourner:** tonic-since-childhood, contented — the uniformity itself unsettled the party ("people say almost the same thing all the time," Anthony noted).
- **Coll:** complains, has no work, **sometimes skips his tonic, gets the dreams, goes back on it** — and Gren asked him to skip it again and talk next time. Coll lit up at the job of taking scouts out for the displacer carcasses and the two lockets left on the wight corpses: "Finally, something to do."
- **Pip:** three-dragon-ante hook planted (Gren bought a set); Pip reported **Selma was nervous/unhappy that the tree is growing** — the session's quietest, sharpest clue, delivered by a child.
- **Oswin:** history from the mayor's line — he and Selma both privately believe the bounty is **the dryad's, not Chauntea's** ("that cleric has never cast a real divine spell in my life"). Confirmed the hag coven / caves / dragon rumors. Identified the woman in the Charcoal Sketch instantly: "That's her. That's the dryad" — from his own childhood dreams. Read Marn's Journal aloud. **The Graveheart nearly slipped** — Tom said "heart" twice; ruled as misheard, no reveal. Then the tree: **first new buds in the town's living memory**, announced with Oswin present — "double heroes."

- **The tree test:** Jetten walked in with the shard pouched — **the Graveheart beats harder near the tree, softer walking away.** Clean diegetic confirmation of the link; the party said it out loud to each other afterward.

4 · Night two — the answer

Same dream, same greeting ("Corin? ...Stay this time"). This time **Jetten held out the Graveheart. Her eyes widened — and the dream ended.** Morning: Thomas fully recovered, cane done with. (Dream A.1's repeat + response beat improvised cleanly; her reaction is now a live thread.)

5 · The plate, the council, the purse

- Gully's plate delivered. Roll-off for it: Morgash **2**, Thomas **3**, Gren (not even eligible) **19** — "neither of you deserves it." Thomas took it: **AC 22** (plate + +1 shield + cloak). One splint suit sold for 100 gp in the shuffle; Morgash stays in splint.
- Antitoxins distributed one per PC (green-dragon poison talk drove the buy — they're deliberately keeping the dragon for later, knowing it's poison).
- **Destination council: the Widow Fen.** Dragon deferred ("baby dragon still fierce"), the fen is closest; Thomas's earlier worry about the hags has faded. **The script's soft-steer away from the fen did not hold — the coven meets them at ONE shard.** See gm-notes.

6 · The road out — Longshadow

- Staged beats fired in order: man-shaped shadow on the ground (Jetten's Survival 24 caught it; Perception 8 missed the source — so the first pass kept its mystery), then Gren's **Speak with Animals** (free cast) got the name from the squirrels: "**Longshadow** — flying stag, feeds on people, time to hide."

- **Fight:** Longshadow + **2 perytons** (second added live), opening at elevation 60. Initiative: Jetten 20, Gren 17, Longshadow 17, Morgash 14, perytons 13/8, Thomas 8.
 - Jetten opened with *Hunter's Mark* + longbow 26/9 + **Dread Ambusher** (+2d6) — and then spent the whole fight as the flock's favorite meal, failing concentration twice (the two checks off Longshadow's Gore+Talons multiattack were both legitimate — verified vs the doubling bug, each check maps to its own hit).
 - Gren: free Fey-Touched *Bless* on three; *Innate Sorcery* + *Scorching Ray* — **two crits that dealt 19 total** (damage dice 1,2,2,1); *Fire Bolt* crit later for 2. The advantage engine worked; the dice did not.
 - Thomas: javelin miss 8 → **Heroic Inspiration** → **16, hit** (+ Slow); new plate turned every peryton attack all fight; **First Light + Sap, then Shield Master bash** → **prone** (failed DC 14 by 3); killed the last peryton with First Light (22/13).
 - **Morgash: Maul of Momentum 26/16 — Longshadow dead in one swing** (GWM Hew triggered, no adjacent target). Next round: Greataxe adv 25/10 → Cleave → maul miss 12 → **Precision Attack (+2 = 14) hit** → **Action Surge** Greataxe 25/11 **killed peryton #2** → Hew 15/4. A complete Battle Master showcase in two turns.
 - **Teaching beats landed:** elevation mechanic introduced; **Ready action taught** and Anthony used it verbatim round 1 ("If it comes near us, I trigger the attack"); prone vs ranged/melee explained; "no Pythagorean theorem" ruling stated.
- **Harvest:** 6 peryton feathers (3d4); Gren gave one to a squirrel as proof of the kill and launched a forest-wide PR campaign ("Gren the Mighty has slain Longshadow!"); six squirrels returned bearing acorn tribute. **Stash: 5× Peryton Feather (10 gp ea), 6× Acorn (1 sp).**
- Short rest at the ruin; Jetten spent 3 hit dice (2+3+10). Morgash claimed **the Graveheart and the Periapt of Wound Closure** to attune (he has both slots free).

7 · Wrap

- **Level 5 announced** — players instructed to level in downtime. Morgash's level-up done at the table (Extra Attack, Tactical Shift, HP 59); Gren/Jetten/Thomas pending.
 - Session ended at the ruin mid-journey to the Widow Fen — next session cold-opens on the road/at the fen.
 - Scheduling: aiming **Monday 2026-08-31** (Anthony arranging); Andrew flies to Madrid Tuesday.
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Recorded at the table — transcribed & chronicled by the party scribe.